

Software Project Planning Guide

A practical checklist for defining a software project before development begins.

1. Business objective

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| ■ What business problem are we solving? |
| ■ Who owns the outcome? |
| ■ What measurable result should improve? |
| ■ What is the cost of not solving it? |

2. Users and journeys

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| ■ Who are the primary users? |
| ■ What is the main user journey? |
| ■ What are the highest-friction steps? |
| ■ What accessibility or device constraints exist? |

3. MVP scope

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| ■ What must launch in version 1? |
| ■ What can wait until later? |
| ■ Which integrations are mandatory? |
| ■ What are the acceptance criteria? |

4. Technical planning

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| ■ Frontend framework and reusable components |
| ■ Backend/API architecture |
| ■ Database and data ownership |
| ■ Authentication and authorization |
| ■ Hosting, environments and monitoring |

5. Delivery plan

■ Discovery and requirements
■ UX/UI and design system
■ Engineering and integration
■ QA and security review
■ Launch and post-launch monitoring

6. Growth and measurement

■ Which KPIs define success?
■ How will leads/conversions be measured?
■ What analytics events are required?
■ What should be tested after launch?

Final launch checklist

■ Business goal agreed ■ MVP scope approved ■ Designs reviewed ■ API/data model defined ■ QA completed
■ Analytics connected ■ Production environment configured ■ Backup/rollback plan ready